

FREE GUIDE

Allowable Business Expenses Cheat Sheet

A quick-reference guide to what small businesses in Ireland can typically claim.

Usually Allowable

- ✓ Office supplies & equipment
- ✓ Business insurance
- ✓ Professional fees (accountant, solicitor)
- ✓ Business-use proportion of your home
- ✓ Business travel & subsistence
- ✓ Marketing & advertising
- ✓ Software & subscriptions used for business
- ✓ Staff wages & employer PRSI
- ✓ Business-use proportion of phone & internet
- ✓ Motor expenses (business proportion, with mileage records)

Usually NOT Allowable

- ✗ Personal or private expenses
- ✗ Client entertainment (generally not deductible)
- ✗ Fines and penalties
- ✗ Personal clothing (unless a genuine uniform or protective wear)
- ✗ Capital purchases (claimed via capital allowances, not as a direct expense)
- ✗ Personal drawings or your own wages as a sole trader

This is general guidance, not tax advice — allowability can depend on your specific circumstances. Always confirm with your accountant or Revenue before claiming.